NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 2 • 1569–1588

Challenges to Elizabeth at Home and Abroad, 1569–88



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD: The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I (c. 1588)

WOBURN ABBEY COLLECTION • BEDFORDSHIRE • WA-INV-042

EXAM FOCUS **Q1(a) Feature:** 2m [3 min] • **Q1(b) Feature:** 2m [3 min] • **Q2 Causation:** 12m [18 min] **TARGET GRADE:**

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE SPECIFICATION FRAMEWORK • KEY TOPIC 2

4 MODULAR ENQUIRIES

TOPIC 2.1 • PLOTS AND REVOLTS AT HOME

- The reasons for, and significance of, the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70.
- The features and significance of the Ridolfi, Throckmorton and Babington plots. Walsingham and the use of spies.
- The reasons for, and significance of, Mary Queen of Scots' execution in 1587.

TOPIC 2.2 • RELATIONS WITH SPAIN

- Political, religious and commercial rivalry.
- The significance of privateering and the activities of Drake.

TOPIC 2.3 • OUTBREAK OF WAR WITH SPAIN, 1585–88

- Reasons for deteriorating relations with Spain: English direct involvement in the Netherlands and the actions of Robert Dudley.
- Drake and the raid on Cadiz: 'Singeing the King of Spain's beard'.

TOPIC 2.4 • THE ARMADA

- Spanish invasion plans. Key events of the Spanish Armada.
- The reasons for the English victory.

Northern Earls, Papal Bull, Plots & Mary's Execution

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS: At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Rebellions & Foreign Plots to the left • Spycraft & Royal Retaliation to the right).

◂ DURHAM MASS & NORFOLK PLAN

NOV 1569 Revolt of the Northern Earls (KT 2.1)

450 REBELS EXECUTED NORTH ▸

◂ REGNANS IN EXCELSIS BULL

1570–71 Papal Bull & Ridolfi Plot (KT 2.1)

1571 TREASON ACT & NORFOLK ▸

◂ GUISE PLAN & CIPHER BARRELS

1583–86 Throckmorton & Babington Plots (KT 2.1)

WALSINGHAM SPY NETWORK ▸

◂ TREASON TRIAL & WARRANT

FEB 1587 Execution of Mary, Queen of Scots (KT 2.1)

MARTYRDOM & PHILIP II FURY ▸

SPECIFICATION SPINE CONTINUES TO SPAIN, NETHERLANDS & THE ARMADA (PAGE 3) ➔

"1569: The Northern Earls marched with Catholic banners; Elizabeth responded with 450 executions."

Anglo-Spanish Rivalry, War in the Netherlands & The Armada

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS: At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Commercial & Military Clashes to the left • Strategic & Naval Outcomes to the right).

◂ NEW WORLD TRADE & SILVER

1572–80 **Spanish Rivalry & Drake Privateering** (KT 2.2)

£140K CACAFUEGO & DEPTFORD ▸

◂ PACIFICATION & JOINVILLE

AUG 1585 **Treaty of Nonsuch & Dutch War** (KT 2.3)

DUDLEY'S 7,400 TROOPS SENT ▸

◂ 30 SHIPS & BARREL STAVES

APR 1587 **Drake's Raid on Cadiz Harbour** (KT 2.3)

ARMADA DELAYED BY ONE YEAR ▸

◂ CALAIS FIRESHIPS & GALLEONS

JUL–AUG 1588 **Defeat of the Spanish Armada** (KT 2.4)

GRAVELINES & STORM WRECKS ▸

KEY TOPIC 2 SPECIFICATION SPINE COMPLETE ➔

Why did Catholic plots fail to overthrow Elizabeth between 1569 and 1587?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 NOV 1569–JAN 1570 • Why did the Northern Earls fail to overthrow Elizabeth despite capturing Durham Cathedr...

- Latin Mass at Durham Cathedral
- Spanish Troops Fail to Land
- Four Hundred and Fifty Executions

2 1570–1571 • How did the 1570 Papal Bull transform the legal and political danger facing English Catholics?

- Regnans in Excelsis Excommunication
- Italian Banker Conspiracy Courier
- Norfolk Beheaded on Tower Hill

3 1583–1584 • Why did the discovery of the Throckmorton Plot lead to harsher anti-Catholic measures?

- French Duke of Guise Invasion Plan
- Philip II Provides 200,000 Ducats
- Vow to Execute Any Claimant

4 1586 • How did Walsingham use espionage and deciphered correspondence to trap Mary Stuart?

- Letters in Waterproof Beer Barrels
- Phelippes Decodes Gallows Cipher
- Explicit Approval of Regicide

5 FEB 1587 • Why was Elizabeth so reluctant to execute Mary Queen of Scots despite proven treason?

- 1585 Safety Act Indictment
- Fotheringhay Castle Great Hall Block
- Divine Right Monarchical Martyrdom

"Walsingham's codebreaker Thomas Phelippes decoded the beer barrel letters: detail matters!"

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B)

Score: / 12

Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots was executed in 1587. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The Babington Plot • The Treaty of Nonsuch ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

 Score: / 12

Conclude your question 2 explain why and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569). [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2021 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the Babington Plot (1586). [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

MIND-MAP MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 and branch out the 1569 Northern Earls, 1570–86 Catholic Plots, and 1587 Mary Execution nodes using Consolidate Station keywords. ← **Pages 2–3**

 "Forensic detail: the Bond of Association (1584) sealed Mary Stuart's fate before Babington wrote."

Was war between England and Spain inevitable from the moment Elizabeth took the throne?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1570–1577 • Why did Spanish control of the Netherlands threaten English trade and security?

- Antwerp Deep-Water Ports Threat
- William of Orange Protestant Rebellion
- Funding Sea Beggars Privateers

2 1570–1579 • Why did English privateering in the Caribbean inflame diplomatic tensions with Spain?

- Spanish Monopoly on American Bullion
- Nombre de Dios Mule Train Ambush
- Queen Licences Legal Piracy

3 1577–1580 • Why did Drake's circumnavigation represent a direct challenge to the Spanish Empire?

- Cacafuego Surrenders £140,000 Treasure
- Uncharted Pacific Raids on Peru
- Golden Hind Knighthood Defiance

4 1581–1584 • How did events in Europe between 1580 and 1584 increase the threat of a Spanish invasion?

- Philip II Inherits Portuguese Crown
- Assassination of William of Orange
- French Catholic Guise League Accord

5 1584–1585 • Why did the Treaty of Nonsuch mark the point of no return for war between England and Spain?

- French-Spanish Secret Catholic Pact
- 7,400 English Troops under Dudley
- Direct Military Confrontation Declared

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B) | **Score: / 20**

"Commercial rivalry was the main cause of conflict between England and Spain in the years 1576–85." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

You may use in your answer: • Drake's raid on the West Indies • Religious differences ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *To a large extent, it can be argued that... • A decisive factor supporting this view was... • Specifically, this was important because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • In particular, ... • In conclusion, the decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

Enquiry 2.2: Relations with Spain and commercial rivalry • Question 3 Evaluative Essay Continued

Score: / 20

Conclude your question 3 evaluative essay and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL SPECIFICATION FOCUS** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of English privateering against Spain. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Francis Drake's raid on Cadiz (1587). [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

MIND-MAP MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 and branch out the 1572–80 Spanish Rivalry & Drake Privateering node on your mind-map using Consolidate Station keywords. ← **Pages 2–3**

Why did English intervention in the Netherlands force Philip II to launch the Armada?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 DEC 1585–1586 • Why did Dudley's campaign in the Netherlands struggle to achieve decisive military success?

- Governor-General Title Angers Elizabeth
- Underfunded & Deserting English Troops
- Prevents Parma Capturing Deep Ports

2 1586–1587 • How did English betrayals and command disputes damage relations with the Dutch rebels?

- Sir Philip Sidney Mortally Wounded
- Stanley & Yorke Betray Dutch Forts
- Dutch Council of State Distrust

3 APRIL 1587 • How did Drake's tactical boldness at Cadiz disrupt the Spanish invasion timetable?

- Thirty Spanish Warships Destroyed
- 'Singeing the King of Spain's Beard'
- Postpones Armada by Twelve Months

4 1587–1588 • Why were logistical damage and command changes fatal to the Spanish invasion plan?

- Destroyed Fleet Provisions & Supplies
- Santa Cruz Dies; Medina Sidonia Inexperienced
- Rotting Food & Leaking Water Casks

5 MAY–JULY 1588 • What strategic flaws made Philip II's plan to link the fleet with Parma extremely risky?

- 130 Ships & 30,000 Men Depart
- Parma Lacks Deep-Water Harbor in Shallows
- Unreliable 48-Hour Message Relay

"Treaty of Nonsuch (1585): Dudley's 7,400 troops in the Netherlands made war with Spain inevitable."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B) Score: / 12

Explain why England became involved in the Netherlands in 1585. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:	• The assassination of William of Orange	• The Treaty of Joinville	***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

Enquiry 2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88 • Question 2 Explain Why Continued

Score: / 12

Conclude your question 2 explain why and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585). [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Robert Dudley's campaign in the Netherlands. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

MIND-MAP MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 and branch out the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch & Dutch War and 1587 Raid on Cadiz nodes using Consolidate Station keywords. ← **Pages 2–3**

"Tactical breakdown: English race-built galleons versus high Spanish castles in the Channel duel."

Did brilliant English tactics or fatal Spanish blunders defeat the Armada in 1588?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 JULY 1588 • Why were English ships unable to break the Armada's crescent formation in open Channel water?

- Seven-Mile Crescent Defensive Line
- Long-Range Culverin Duel Beyond Boarding
- Anchorage Denied in Deep Solent

2 7–8 AUG 1588 • Why did the English use of fireships at Calais prove the decisive turning point of the campaign?

- Eight Pitch-Soaked Vessels at Midnight
- Panic-Stricken Spanish Ships Cut Anchors
- Shattered Crescent Never Reforms

3 8 AUG 1588 • How did English ship design and gunnery tactics defeat Spanish warships at Gravelines?

- Hawkins' Low Race-Built Galleons
- Rapid-Fire Broadside Gunnery Close Range
- Three Galleons Sunk & Fleet Scattered

4 AUG–SEPT 1588 • Why did the combination of adverse weather and lost equipment destroy the retreating Armada?

- Gale-Force 'Protestant Wind' Drives North
- Missing Anchors on Scottish & Irish Reefs
- Only Sixty-Seven Battered Ships Return

5 1588–1589 • How did the defeat of the Armada transform Elizabeth's reputation at home and abroad?

- Tilbury Speech: 'Heart & Stomach of a King'
- 'God Blew and They Were Scattered' Medals
- Protestant Naval Superpower Prestige

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B) | **Score: / 20**

"The tactics of the English navy were the main reason for the defeat of the Spanish Armada." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

You may use in your answer: • Fireships at Calais • The weather ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *To a large extent, it can be argued that... • A decisive factor supporting this view was... • Specifically, this was important because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • In particular, ... • In conclusion, the decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

 Score: / 20

Conclude your question 3 evaluative essay and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the Spanish Armada's crescent formation. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2021 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of English naval tactics during the Armada campaign. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

MIND-MAP MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 and branch out the Jul–Aug 1588 Defeat of the Spanish Armada node on your mind-map using Consolidate Station keywords. ← **Pages 2–3**

PUPIL NAME: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐

#	ENQUIRY / SPECIFICATION FOCUS	DO NOW (10M)	Q1(A) FEAT (2M)	Q1(B) FEAT (2M)	EXTENDED TASK	MODULE TOTAL
1	**KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home, 1569–87** *"Why did Catholic plots fail to overthrow Elizabeth between 1569 and 1587?"* **HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed* **Home Quiz:** _____ / 10 **Parent Sign:** _____	_____ / 10	_____ / 2	_____ / 2	**Q2 Explain:** _____ / 12	_____ / 26
2	**KT2.2: Relations with Spain and commercial rivalry** *"Was war between England and Spain inevitable from the moment Elizabeth took the throne?"* **HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed* **Home Quiz:** _____ / 10 **Parent Sign:** _____	_____ / 10	_____ / 2	_____ / 2	**Q3 Essay:** _____ / 20	_____ / 34
3	**KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88** *"Why did English intervention in the Netherlands force Philip II to launch the Armada?"* **HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed* **Home Quiz:** _____ / 10 **Parent Sign:** _____	_____ / 10	_____ / 2	_____ / 2	**Q2 Explain:** _____ / 12	_____ / 26
4	**KT2.4: The Spanish Armada, 1588** *"Did brilliant English tactics or fatal Spanish blunders defeat the Armada in 1588?"* **HW Set:** _____ **Due:** _____ ☐ *Read & Quizzed* **Home Quiz:** _____ / 10 **Parent Sign:** _____	_____ / 10	_____ / 2	_____ / 2	**Q3 Essay:** _____ / 20	_____ / 34